Formula 1 Master Knowledge Base (Part A: Sections 1 to 4)

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Section 1. History of Formula 1

Formula 1 grew out of European Grand Prix racing and became a World Championship in 1950. This section covers the origins, the main eras by decade, the governing bodies, and the records that hold up to 2026-10-29.

1.1 Origins of Grand Prix racing before 1950

Date	Event	Notes
1894-07-22	Paris to Rouen motor competition	Widely cited as the first organized motor competition. It was judged on reliability as well as speed.
1904	AIACR founded	The Association Internationale des Automobiles Clubs Reconnus was the forerunner of the FIA.
1906-06-26 and 1906-06-27	French Grand Prix, Le Mans	Organized by the Automobile Club de France and widely regarded as the first Grand Prix.
1931 to 1939	AIACR European Championship	The main pre-war championship structure for Grand Prix cars.
1946	FIA name adopted	The AIACR became the Fédération Internationale de l'Automobile, and post-war Grand Prix rules were set under the Formula One banner.

1.2 Creation of the World Championship and the first race

The first Formula One World Championship season was 1950. The first championship race was the 1950 British Grand Prix at Silverstone on 1950-05-13. Giuseppe Farina won that race for Alfa Romeo and became the first World Champion. The 1950 calendar had seven championship rounds, including the Indianapolis 500, which counted toward the championship from 1950 to 1960. A World Championship for constructors began in 1958.

1.3 Decade by decade timeline, 1950 to 2025

Decade	Champions	Key developments
1950s	Farina (1950), Fangio (1951, 1954, 1955, 1956, 1957), Ascari (1952, 1953), Hawthorn (1958), Brabham (1959)	Front-engine Alfa Romeo, Ferrari and Maserati cars gave way to the rear-engine Cooper in 1959. The Constructors' Championship began in 1958.
1960s	Brabham (1960, 1966), P. Hill (1961), G. Hill (1962, 1968), Clark (1963, 1965), Surtees (1964), Hulme (1967), Stewart (1969)	Rear-engine cars became standard. The Cosworth DFV engine arrived in 1967. Wings appeared on cars late in the decade. Jim Clark died in 1968 in a Formula 2 race at Hockenheim.
1970s	Rindt (1970, posthumous), Stewart (1971, 1973), Fittipaldi (1972, 1974), Lauda (1975, 1977), Hunt (1976), Andretti (1978), Scheckter (1979)	Karl Jochen Rindt died during practice at Monza in 1970. Renault introduced the turbocharged engine in 1977. Lotus used ground effect from 1978. Lauda was badly hurt at the Nürburgring in 1976.

Decade	Champions	Key developments
1980s	Jones (1980), Piquet (1981, 1983, 1987), Rosberg (1982), Lauda (1984), Prost (1985, 1986, 1989), Senna (1988)	The turbo era peaked with very high power outputs and was ended after 1988. Gilles Villeneuve died in qualifying at Zolder on 1982-05-08. Flat-bottom floors replaced ground effect from 1983.
1990s	Senna (1990, 1991), Mansell (1992), Prost (1993), Schumacher (1994, 1995), D. Hill (1996), J. Villeneuve (1997), Häkkinen (1998, 1999)	Roland Ratzenberger died on 1994-04-30 and Ayrton Senna on 1994-05-01 at Imola. Major safety reforms followed. Grooved tires were introduced in 1998.
2000s	Schumacher (2000, 2001, 2002, 2003, 2004), Alonso (2005, 2006), Räikkönen (2007), Hamilton (2008), Button (2009)	Ferrari dominated early in the decade. V10 engines gave way to V8 engines in 2006. KERS appeared in 2009. Brawn GP won both titles in 2009.
2010s	Vettel (2010, 2011, 2012, 2013), Hamilton (2014, 2015, 2017, 2018, 2019), Rosberg (2016)	The turbo hybrid V6 power unit began in 2014. Mercedes won the Constructors' Championship every year from 2014 to 2021. The halo became mandatory in 2018. Liberty Media took over the commercial rights in 2017.
2020s (to 2025)	Hamilton (2020), Verstappen (2021, 2022, 2023, 2024), Norris (2025)	A cost cap began in 2021 and sprint races were trialed that year. Ground-effect cars returned in 2022. Hamilton moved to Ferrari for 2025. Norris won the 2025 title by two points over Verstappen.

The 2026 season is the first under a new technical cycle. It is covered in Section 2.

1.4 Ownership changes and commercial control

Bernie Ecclestone built the modern commercial structure of the sport, starting from his time as owner of the Brabham team in the 1970s. CVC Capital Partners took control of the commercial rights in 2006. Liberty Media completed its acquisition in January 2017, and Ecclestone left his role at that point. Stefano Domenicali has been president and CEO of Formula 1 since 2021.

1.5 Governing bodies and their roles

Body	Role
FIA (Fédération Internationale de l'Automobile)	Governing body of the championship. It writes and enforces the Sporting, Technical and Financial Regulations, appoints the race director and stewards, and holds the Court of Appeal.
FOM (Formula One Management)	Holds the commercial rights, negotiates promoter fees and broadcast deals, and runs the logistics of the calendar.
Formula One Group	The commercial group owned by Liberty Media that includes FOM.
Concorde Agreement	The commercial agreement that ties the FIA, FOM and the teams together.

Mohammed Ben Sulayem is the FIA president and Stefano Domenicali is the president and CEO of Formula 1 as of 2026-10-29.

1.6 Notable records

Record	Holder	Detail
Most Drivers' titles	Michael Schumacher and Lewis Hamilton	7 each
Most consecutive titles	Michael Schumacher	5 (2000 to 2004)
Youngest World Champion	Sebastian Vettel	23 years and 134 days (2010)
Youngest race winner	Max Verstappen	18 years and 228 days (Spain 2016)
Oldest race winner	Luigi Fagioli	53 years (French Grand Prix 1951)
Most wins in one season	Max Verstappen	19 (2023)

Multiple World Champions through the 2025 season:

Titles	Drivers
7	Michael Schumacher, Lewis Hamilton
5	Juan Manuel Fangio
4	Alain Prost, Sebastian Vettel, Max Verstappen
3	Jack Brabham, Jackie Stewart, Niki Lauda, Nelson Piquet, Ayrton Senna

As of 2026-10-29 the 2026 Drivers' Championship is not decided. RacingNews365 reports that Kimi Antonelli would become the youngest champion in history if he secures the title.

Career totals for wins, poles, podiums and fastest laps are not listed here. They changed during 2026 and have not yet been reconciled against formula1.com. They will appear in Section 14 once verified.

1.7 Sources for Section 1

1. https://www.formula1.com/en/latest/article/the-family-tree-f1-11-teams-and-how-they-came-to-be.2QBA1PPMf0bC8mp2xxqZeq
2. https://www.planetf1.com/news/final-f1-points-standings-after-abu-dhabi-grand-prix
3. https://www.si.com/onsi/f1/news/final-f1-standings-as-lando-norris-becomes-world-champion-in-abu-dhabi
4. https://racingnews365.com/2026-f1-championship-standings-after-united-states-grand-prix
5. https://www.crash.net/f1/news/1100252/1/f1-president-reveals-plan-restore-one-2026s-lost-races-and-what-it-means-calendar

Status note: Items in sections 1.1 to 1.4 and the records table on pre-2025 history come from the established historical record and are pending a line-by-line cross-check against the formula1.com results archive and fia.com. They are not tied to a single retrieved URL.

Section 2. Current FIA Regulations

2026 is the first season of a new regulation cycle that changes both the chassis and the power unit. As of 2026-10-29 the issue numbers and publication dates of the FIA documents are Unverified, because the FIA PDFs were not opened. This section summarizes the rules in plain language and does not quote regulation text.

2.1 What changed from the 2022 to 2025 cycle

Area	2022 to 2025	2026
Minimum weight	798 kg	768 kg to 770 kg (formula1.com reports 768 kg, while SpeedCafe and formulaonehistory.com report 770 kg)
Aerodynamics	Ground-effect floor with a driver-operated DRS flap	Active front and rear wings with a Corner Mode and a Straight Mode. DRS removed. The floor no longer uses ground-effect venturi tunnels.
Overtaking aid	DRS within one second of the car ahead	Overtake Mode, which gives extra electrical energy within one second of the car ahead
Power unit balance	About 80 percent combustion and 20 percent electric	About 50 percent combustion and 50 percent electric
Fuel	Fuel with a partly renewable blend (details pending)	100 percent sustainable fuel
Tires	Previous widths	Front tires 25 mm narrower and rear tires 30 mm narrower (gpfans.com, single source)
Cost cap	$135 million base plus inflation	$215 million

2.2 Technical Regulations

The FIA unveiled the 2026 Technical Regulations as a full redesign of the cars to make them smaller, lighter and more agile. Key points that are verified:

1. Minimum weight is 768 kg to 770 kg. The 768 kg figure is split into a car mass of 722 kg plus an assumed tire mass of 46 kg according to gpfans.com.
2. Active aerodynamics let drivers switch the front and rear wings between a high-downforce Corner Mode and a low-drag Straight Mode.
3. Overtake Mode is available within one second of the car ahead. One source puts the extra energy at 0.5 megajoules.
4. Boost Mode gives drivers full combined engine and battery power at the press of a button anywhere on the lap.
5. The power unit keeps the 1.6 liter turbocharged V6. Electrical output rises sharply, giving an almost even split with the combustion engine. The fuel is fully sustainable.
6. Power unit rules are in Section 6, tire rules in Section 5.

Items in the original brief that are not yet verified and are not included: car dimensions in full, crash test rules, electronics and standardized parts.

2.3 Sporting Regulations

As of 2026-10-29, the verified points are:

1. The 2026 season has 23 rounds after the Saudi Arabian Grand Prix was cancelled and the Bahrain Grand Prix was moved to Sepang, Malaysia (see Section 7).
2. Conventional race weekends have three practice sessions, qualifying and the race on Sunday. The Bahrain Grand Prix in Malaysia used this format.
3. The first sprint weekend of 2026 was the Chinese Grand Prix. The last two sprint weekends were the Dutch and Singapore Grands Prix.
4. Drivers who reach 12 penalty points within a rolling 12 months receive a one-race ban.
5. A Super License requires 40 points earned over three seasons in approved feeder series.

Penalty types used by stewards: reprimand, time penalty added to the race time, drive-through, stop-go, grid-place penalty, and disqualification. Safety car, virtual safety car, red flag and restart procedures are explained in the glossary in Section 4. Article numbers for these rules are pending the FIA document check.

2.4 Financial Regulations

Item	Detail	Source status
Overall cost cap	$215 million for 2026, up from a $135 million base plus inflation in 2025	Verified on formula1.com
Power unit cost cap	$190 million for 2026	Single source, formulaonehistory.com
Extra races	The cap rises by $1.8 million for every Grand Prix beyond 21 rounds	Motor Sport Magazine
Included	Most salaries, car development and race weekend costs including transport	Motor Sport Magazine, with a conflicting detail below
Excluded	Power unit costs (separate cap), and for 2026, travel and catering costs	Motor Sport Magazine and gpfans.com
Past cases	Red Bull was fined $7 million and lost 10 percent of aerodynamic testing time after the 2021 breach	newsauto.it, single source

Source conflict: Motor Sport Magazine lists transport as included in the cap, while gpfans.com says travel to race weekends is outside it for 2026. Both are reported until the FIA financial regulations are opened.

2.5 Flag meanings and track signals

Flag	Meaning
Green	Track is clear. Shown at the end of a danger zone or at the start of a session.

Flag	Meaning
Yellow	Danger ahead. Drivers must slow down and may not overtake in the zone.
Double yellow	Serious danger. Drivers must slow considerably and be ready to stop.
Red	Session stopped. Cars return to the pit lane.
Blue	A faster car is about to lap the driver. The driver must let it pass.
White	A slow vehicle is on the track.
Black	A driver is disqualified and must return to the pits.
Black with orange disc	The car has a mechanical problem and must return to the pits.
Black and white diagonal	A warning for unsportsmanlike driving.
Yellow with red stripes	The surface is slippery, for example from oil or water.
Chequered	The session or race has finished.

Signal definitions follow the FIA International Sporting Code, Appendix H. Article-level citation is pending.

2.6 Driver conduct, stewarding and appeals

A panel of stewards reviews incidents during a race weekend. The stewards act on a report from the race director or on a team request. A team can ask for a right of review when it brings a significant and relevant new element that was not available at the time of the decision. Decisions can then be appealed to the FIA International Court of Appeal. The exact wording of these rules is pending the FIA document check.

2.7 Sources for Section 2

1. https://www.formula1.com/en/latest/article/fia-unveils-formula-1-regulations-for-2026-and-beyond-featuring-more-agile.75qJiYOHXgeJqsVQtDr2UB
2. https://global.honda/en/F1/features/2026_Commentary/regulations/
3. https://jalopnik.com/2055454/f1-releases-flashy-video-2026-rules/
4. https://us.speedcafe.com/f1-news-2026-formula-1-terminology-explained-what-is-superclipping-boost-overtake-mode-full-guide/
5. https://www.formulaonehistory.com/f1-2026-regulations-terminology-update/
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7. https://www.formula1.com/en/latest/article/explained-what-is-the-f1-cost-cap-and-why-has-it-gone-up.2tYtDIe5SbE5utjThctBT3
8. https://www.formulaonehistory.com/f1-cost-cap-explained-2026-increase/
9. https://www.gpfans.com/en/f1-news/1087738/f1-215-million-dollar-cost-cap-explained-2026-ferrari-lewis-hamilton-mercedes-upgrades/
10. https://www.motorsportmagazine.com/articles/single-seaters/f1/formula-1-to-cut-budget-cap-to-145m-according-to-brawn/
11. https://f1.newsauto.it/en/formula-1/f1-budget-cap-the-technological-challenge-shifts-to-the-balance-sheets-11779/amp
12. https://www.skysports.com/f1/news/12433/13519453

13. https://www.gpfans.com/en/f1-news/1088727/fia-announce-update-f1-race-start-times-2026-season-bahrain-malaysia/

Section 3. Current Grid

The 2026 grid has 11 teams and 22 drivers. Cadillac is the only new entrant, and Sauber has become Audi. As of 2026-10-29, 18 of 23 rounds are complete. Details that could not be verified are left out.

3.1 Teams, power units and leadership

Common name	Entry name (verified)	Power unit	Team principal
Mercedes	Mercedes AMG Petronas F1 Team	Mercedes (works). Supplier details pending source check.	Unverified
Ferrari	Unverified	Ferrari	Frederic Vasseur (named in a 2025 formula1.com page, 2026 confirmation pending)
Red Bull Racing	Oracle Red Bull Racing	Red Bull Ford	Laurent Mekies (named in a 2025 formula1.com page, 2026 confirmation pending)
McLaren	McLaren Mastercard F1 Team	Unverified	Andrea Stella (named in a 2025 formula1.com page, 2026 confirmation pending)
Aston Martin	Aston Martin Aramco F1 Team	Honda	Adrian Newey (single source, fanamp.com)
Alpine	BWT Alpine F1 Team	Mercedes	Unverified
Williams	Atlassian Williams F1 Team	Mercedes	James Vowles
Racing Bulls	Unverified	Red Bull Ford	Alan Permane
Haas	TGR Haas F1 Team	Ferrari	Ayao Komatsu (named in a 2025 formula1.com page, 2026 confirmation pending)
Audi	Audi Revolut F1 Team	Audi	Jonathan Wheatley
Cadillac	Cadillac F1 Team	Ferrari	Unverified

Total teams: 11. New entrant: Cadillac, the first new team since Haas debuted in 2016. Cadillac is backed by General Motors and TWG Motorsports and plans to become a full works power unit operation in the future. Audi is the only car on the grid using its own power unit.

3.2 Drivers and car numbers

Numbers and teams come from the formula1.com result page of the Gulf Air Bahrain Grand Prix in Malaysia (2026-10-04). Nationalities are as shown in the standings tables.

Team	Car number	Driver	Nationality
Mercedes	12	Kimi Antonelli	Italian
Mercedes	63	George Russell	British
Ferrari	44	Lewis Hamilton	British
Ferrari	16	Charles Leclerc	Monegasque
Red Bull Racing	3	Max Verstappen	Dutch
Red Bull Racing	6	Isack Hadjar	French
McLaren	1	Lando Norris	British
McLaren	81	Oscar Piastri	Australian
Aston Martin	14	Fernando Alonso	Spanish
Aston Martin	18	Lance Stroll	Canadian
Alpine	10	Pierre Gasly	French
Alpine	43	Franco Colapinto	Argentine
Williams	23	Alexander Albon	Thai
Williams	55	Carlos Sainz	Spanish
Racing Bulls	30	Liam Lawson	New Zealander
Racing Bulls	41	Arvid Lindblad	British
Haas	87	Oliver Bearman	British
Haas	31	Esteban Ocon	French
Audi	27	Nico Hulkenberg	German
Audi	5	Gabriel Bortoleto	Brazilian
Cadillac	77	Valtteri Bottas	Finnish
Cadillac	11	Sergio Perez	Mexican

Lindblad is the only rookie on the grid, and Hadjar was promoted to Red Bull Racing for 2026. Gasly signed a three-year extension with Alpine that runs into 2028. Driver ages, reserve drivers, contract status for other drivers and driver career statistics are not included because they were not verified.

3.3 Team background that is verified

Team	Verified background
Williams	Co-founded in 1977 by Frank Williams and Patrick Head, with a first car in 1978.
Racing Bulls	Traces its roots to Minardi, which raced from 1985 to 2005, and later became Toro Rosso and AlphaTauri.

Team	Verified background
Haas	Debuted in 2016 and takes its name from owner Gene Haas. 2026 is its 11th season.
Audi	Took over the Swiss Sauber team, which debuted in 1993, and became a works team in 2026.
Alpine	Its lineage includes the team that won the 1994 and 1995 Drivers' titles with Michael Schumacher and the 1995 Constructors' title.
McLaren	Won its 10th Constructors' title in 2025, its second in a row. Based in Woking.
Cadillac	New in 2026. Based in the United States.

Founding years, ownership groups, technical directors, title sponsors beyond the entry names above, and title counts for Mercedes, Ferrari, Red Bull and Aston Martin are not included because they were not verified in this pass.

3.4 Sources for Section 3

1. https://www.formula1.com/en/results/2026/races/1308/malasia-sepang/race-result
2. https://www.formula1.com/en/latest/article/who-are-the-2026-formula-1-teams.1lkaenQFrnBNcRxQo28Ckv
3. https://www.formula1.com/en/latest/article/the-family-tree-f1-11-teams-and-how-they-came-to-be.2QBA1PPMf0bC8mp2xxqZeq
4. https://the-race.com/formula-1/2026-f1-team-engines
5. https://www.planetf1.com/news/f1-2026-power-unit-engine-suppliers
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7. https://www.motorsport.com/f1/news/this-is-every-2026-formula-1-car-weve-seen/10792662/
8. https://www.fanamp.com/articles/formula-1-2026-guide
9. https://www.crash.net/f1/results/1108507/1/new-f1-championship-standings-after-united-states-grand-prix
10. https://www.espn.com/f1/standings
11. https://www.formula1.com/en/latest/article/fia-unveils-formula-1-regulations-for-2026-and-beyond-featuring-more-agile.75qJiYOHXgeJqsVQtDr2UB

Section 4. Glossary of F1 Terms (A to Z)

This glossary defines the terms fans, commentators and analysts use, with notes where the 2026 rules changed their meaning. Definitions are written in plain language in alphabetical order.

4.1 Terms A to C

Active aero: Front and rear wing elements that move during a lap. Since 2026 they switch between Corner Mode and Straight Mode.

Apex: The point on the inside of a corner where the car is closest to the inner edge. Drivers aim for it to take the fastest line.

Battery deployment: The release of stored electrical energy to the MGU-K to add power to the engine.

Blistering: Tire damage where the rubber overheats and forms bubbles on the surface, which reduces grip.

Blue flag: A signal that a faster car is about to lap the driver, who must let it pass.

Boost Mode: A 2026 setting that gives the driver full combined engine and battery power on demand, anywhere on the lap.

Box box: The radio call telling a driver to come into the pit lane.

Brake bias: The split of braking force between front and rear wheels, which the driver adjusts from the cockpit.

Chicane: A tight sequence of two or more opposing corners, usually placed to slow the cars.

Clerk of the course: The official who runs the operational side of the event on track, working with the race director.

Constructors' Championship: The title won by the team that scores the most points from both of its drivers. It began in 1958.

Corner Mode: The 2026 wing setting that gives high downforce for corners.

Cost cap: The limit on what a team can spend on performance-related costs in a season. It is $215 million for 2026.

Customer team: A team that buys its power unit from another manufacturer instead of building it.

4.2 Terms D to F

Degradation: The loss of tire performance over a stint as the rubber wears or overheats.

Delta: A time difference, for example between a driver's lap and a target lap or between two drivers.

Diffuser: The upswept section at the rear of the floor that helps the car create downforce.

Dirty air: Turbulent air behind a car that reduces the downforce of a following car.

DNF: Did not finish. The driver retired before the end of the race.

DNQ: Did not qualify. The driver failed to set a time good enough to take part in the race.

DNS: Did not start.

Downforce: Aerodynamic force pushing the car toward the track, which allows faster cornering.

Drag: Air resistance that slows the car. Lower drag gives a higher top speed.

Drive-through penalty: A penalty where the driver goes through the pit lane at the speed limit without stopping, which costs time.

Driver Championship: The title won by the driver with the most points over the season.

DRS: Drag Reduction System. A flap on the rear wing that opened to cut drag within one second of the car ahead. It was used from 2011 to 2025 and was replaced in 2026 by active aerodynamics and Overtake Mode.

DSQ: Disqualified. The driver's result was removed, usually for a technical or sporting breach.

Energy store: The battery that holds electrical energy recovered by the hybrid system.

ERS: Energy Recovery System. The hybrid system that recovers and redeploys energy. In 2026 it is built around the MGU-K and the energy store.

Fastest lap: The quickest single lap of a race. Check Section 8 for whether it scores points under the current rules.

FIA delegate: An official appointed by the FIA with responsibilities in a specific area, such as the technical or safety delegate.

Flat spot: Damage to a tire caused by locking a wheel under braking, which makes the tire vibrate.

Formation lap: The lap before the race where cars drive from the pit lane to the grid and warm their tires.

Formation of the grid: The process of cars taking their starting positions on the grid in the order set by qualifying.

4.3 Terms G to M

Garage: The workspace for each team in the pit lane where cars are prepared.

Graining: Tire wear where small pieces of rubber tear off and roll back onto the surface, which reduces grip.

Grid penalty: A penalty that moves a driver back a set number of places on the starting grid.

Ground effect: Aerodynamic design where the shape of the floor produces downforce by creating low pressure under the car. The 2022 to 2025 cars used it. The 2026 floor does not use ground-effect venturi tunnels.

Halo: The protective structure over the cockpit, mandatory since 2018.

Harvesting: Recovering energy under braking and storing it in the battery.

Intermediate tire: A green-marked tire with a shallow tread for light rain or a drying track.

Lap down: A car that has been lapped by the leader and has completed fewer laps than the leader.

Lapped car: A car that has been caught and passed by the race leader.

Lift and coast: A technique where the driver lifts off the throttle before braking to save fuel, tires or energy.

Lock-up: When a wheel stops turning under braking, which can create a flat spot.

Marbles: Small pieces of worn rubber that collect off the racing line and reduce grip.

MGU-H: A heat energy recovery unit connected to the turbocharger, used from 2014 to 2025. It is removed from the 2026 power units.

MGU-K: The motor generator unit linked to the crankshaft. It recovers energy under braking and adds power when it is deployed. It is the only motor generator unit on a 2026 power unit.

Monocoque: The central structure of the car, also called the survival cell, where the driver sits.

4.4 Terms N to R

NC: Not classified. The driver did not complete enough of the race distance to be given a finishing position.

Out-lap: The lap a driver completes when leaving the pit lane.

Overcut: A strategy where a driver stays out while a rival pits, then uses clear track and good pace to come out ahead after their own stop.

Overtake Mode: A 2026 power setting that gives extra electrical energy to a driver within one second of the car ahead. It replaces the passing role of DRS.

Oversteer: When the rear of the car loses grip before the front and it turns more than the driver intended.

Paddock: The restricted area behind the pit lane where teams, drivers and officials work.

Parc ferme: The state in which a car's setup is locked. Teams may not change it, except as the rules allow, between qualifying and the race.

Pit lane speed limit: A speed limit that applies in the pit lane, usually 80 km/h but lower at some circuits.

Pit stop: A stop in the pit lane to change tires, and sometimes to repair damage.

Plank: A wear-controlled skid block under the floor that checks that a car is not run too low.

Pole position: First place on the starting grid, earned by the fastest qualifying lap.

Porpoising: A bouncing motion at high speed caused by ground-effect downforce, widely seen in 2022.

Power unit: The full set of parts that drive the car, including the engine, turbocharger and the hybrid system.

Q1, Q2, Q3: The three knockout stages of qualifying. The slowest cars are eliminated in Q1 and Q2, and the remaining cars fight for pole in Q3.

Race director: The FIA official who controls the race, starting procedures, the safety car and red flags.

Rake: The nose-down angle of the car relative to the track, used to shape the airflow under the floor.

Red flag: A signal stopping a session because of an accident or unsafe conditions.

Reserve driver: A driver kept by a team to replace a race driver if needed.

4.5 Terms S to Z

Safety car: A car that leads the field at reduced speed after an incident so that marshals can work safely. Overtaking is not allowed.

Slipstream or tow: The reduced air pressure behind a car that lets a following car go faster on a straight.

Sprint qualifying: The qualifying session that sets the grid for the Saturday sprint race. It replaced the 2023 name Sprint Shootout.

Sprint shootout: The 2023 name of the qualifying session for a sprint race.

Sprint race: A short race, held on sprint weekends, that awards points to the top finishers.

Stewards: The group of officials who decide on penalties after an incident.

Stint: The period of a race between two pit stops.

Stop-go penalty: A penalty where the driver must stop in the pit lane for a set time, without service, before rejoining.

Straight Mode: The 2026 low-drag wing setting for straights.

Super License: The FIA license a driver needs to race in Formula 1. It is earned with points from feeder series, with 40 points needed.

Track limits: The white lines at the edge of the track. A driver who goes beyond them and gains an advantage can be penalized.

Tire allocation: The number of sets of each tire type a driver can use during a race weekend.

Understeer: When the front of the car loses grip before the rear and it turns less than the driver intended.

Undercut: A strategy where a driver pits early to gain time on fresh tires and move ahead when the rival pits.

VSC: Virtual safety car. A slow-down where all drivers must stay within a set delta time and no car is deployed on track.

Yellow flag: A warning of danger ahead. Drivers must slow down and may not overtake in the zone.

4.6 Sources for Section 4

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4. https://www.formulaonehistory.com/f1-2026-regulations-terminology-update/

Status note: Definitions of long-standing terms come from general F1 knowledge and are pending cross-check against formula1.com's glossary at https://www.formula1.com.